

Inter-Self Governance Perimeter as New Coordination Scope

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This work derives from and formalizes the inter-Self coordination architecture introduced in “Inter-Self Coordination via Shared Substrate / Full Aspect Integration” (Li, April 2026), the third paper in the CKS theory series following “Coordination Outside the Model: A Human-Governed Substrate Pattern for AI Systems” (Li, April 2026) and “The Instinct/Reasoning Separation Outside the Model” (Li, April 2026).

Abstract

When two or more CKS-governed Selves participate in a Full Aspect Integration (FAI) event, the shared substrate that mediates their coordination carries a governance perimeter of its own — one that spans across each participating Self's home governance perimeter. This note formalizes that architectural sub-commitment as D1.03: the inter-Self governance perimeter is a new, additive coordination scope that coexists simultaneously with each participating Self's intact home perimeter during the FAI event and terminates at event dissolution without creating permanent inter-organizational governance dependencies. The note states the sub-commitment precisely, characterizes the three governance scopes that operate simultaneously during an active FAI event, develops four key architectural properties of the inter-Self perimeter, maps the perimeter hierarchy across the CKS trilogy, identifies four failure modes this sub-commitment defends against, and provides an operational test for verifying the sub-commitment's presence in a deployed system.

1. The sub-commitment stated

D1.03. When a shared substrate is constructed for a Full Aspect Integration event between two or more CKS-governed Selves, that shared substrate's governance boundary

constitutes a new governance scope — the *inter-Self perimeter* — that spans across the home governance perimeters of the participating Selves. The inter-Self perimeter is additive: it does not absorb, replace, or weaken any participating Self's home perimeter. Each home perimeter continues to operate independently and with full authority over its respective Self's internal architecture throughout the FAI event. The inter-Self perimeter is jointly governed by the governance authorities of the participating Selves per the configuration substrate. At FAI event dissolution, the inter-Self perimeter terminates as a governance scope; the participating Selves' home perimeters continue exactly as they did before the event, without residual inter-organizational governance dependency.

This sub-commitment derives directly from Paper 3's Claim 1, which establishes the shared substrate as the architectural object of inter-Self coordination — temporarily constructed, perimeter-spanning, and governed with all six Paper 1 commitments holding within scope. D1.03 isolates and formalizes the perimeter-spanning property in particular: what it means architecturally that the shared substrate's governance boundary crosses organizational lines without absorbing the organizational governance structures it crosses.

2. Three governance scopes operating simultaneously

The most important architectural fact about an active FAI event is that it does not collapse the participating Selves' governance structures into a single joint one. During the event, three distinct governance scopes exist and operate at the same time.

Home Perimeter A.

This is Self A's governance boundary as established by Paper 2's architecture — the outermost perimeter of Self A's three-level nested structure (cell governance perimeter within cell, aspect governance perimeter within aspect, Self home perimeter at the top). It governs Self A's internal DNA layer, action layer, cells, and aspects. During the FAI event, Home Perimeter A is unchanged. Self A's governance authorities retain their full three rights — inspect, modify, override — over every element of Self A's internal architecture. The FAI event does not interrupt, suspend, or qualify Self A's home governance in any way.

Home Perimeter B.

The same is true for Self B. Home Perimeter B operates independently, with Self B's governance authorities exercising full authority over Self B's internal architecture throughout the FAI event. Home Perimeter B and Home Perimeter A do not merge, subordinate to each other, or require coordination during the event for their respective

home governance to continue functioning. They are, architecturally, fully parallel.

The inter-Self perimeter.

This is the governance boundary of the shared substrate itself — the scope within which the FAI event's content lives and is governed. The inter-Self perimeter spans across both Home Perimeter A and Home Perimeter B. It is not located inside either; it encompasses both in the sense that its governance scope includes content contributed from both Selves' home substrates. Governance authority within the inter-Self perimeter is joint: both Selves' governance authorities participate in governing the shared substrate, per whatever joint-authority mechanics the configuration substrate specifies. The three Paper 1 rights — inspect, modify, override — apply within the inter-Self perimeter as they do at every other scope in the trilogy.

The simultaneity of these three scopes is what the additive property means in architectural terms. At any moment during an active FAI event, an observer can locate three distinct governance scopes with three distinct authority structures: Self A's home governance operating independently over Self A's architecture; Self B's home governance operating independently over Self B's architecture; and the joint governance of the shared substrate operating over the inter-Self perimeter. None of these is suspended on account of the others. None defers to another. The home perimeters were there before the FAI event began and will be there after it ends. The inter-Self perimeter exists precisely for the duration of the event.

3. Four key architectural properties

Property 1: Home perimeters remain intact.

The additive character of the inter-Self perimeter is not merely a description of what happens in practice; it is an architectural commitment. An inter-Self coordination mechanism that weakened, qualified, or temporarily suspended a participating Self's home governance authority as a precondition of coordination would not satisfy D1.03. The commitment requires that Self A can, at any moment during the FAI event, exercise its home governance rights — including override — over its own internal architecture without reference to or approval from Self B, and vice versa. The governance of each home substrate and the governance of the shared substrate are concurrently active, fully operative, and structurally independent of each other.

Property 2: Cross-boundary provenance is governed, not automatic.

When Self A contributes aspects to the shared substrate during an FAI event, the cells and layer content those aspects carry cross the boundary from Home Perimeter A into the inter-Self perimeter. That crossing does not occur without governance. Provenance travels with contributed content — tracing its origin to Self A's home substrate — and the depth to which that cross-perimeter provenance carries within the shared substrate is governance-configured content within the inter-Self perimeter. This configuration is an exercise of joint authority by the participating Selves' governance structures, not an automatic property of the contribution. The inter-Self perimeter governs what crosses its boundary and how far provenance traces once inside.

Property 3: Configuration within the inter-Self perimeter is substrate content.

How joint authority is exercised within the inter-Self perimeter — the approval mechanics, the conflict-handling rules, the sharing scope, the provenance carry-over depth — is itself substrate content within the inter-Self perimeter. It is inspectable by the participating Selves' governance authorities, modifiable under those authorities, and subject to override. The configuration substrate does not live outside governance as a fixed deployment parameter; it lives inside the inter-Self perimeter as authored substrate content, applying all six Paper 1 commitments to governance configuration itself. This property is the basis for D1.02's three rights applying to the inter-Self perimeter: the rights are exercisable over the perimeter's governance configuration because that configuration is substrate content subject to those rights.

Property 4: Dissolution terminates the inter-Self perimeter.

When the FAI event completes, the inter-Self perimeter ceases to exist as a governance scope. It does not persist in a reduced or dormant form; it is not archived as a standing governance relationship between the two Selves; it does not leave behind any continuing inter-organizational governance obligation or authority structure. The home perimeters of Self A and Self B continue exactly as they did before the event began. No permanent governance dependency between Self A and Self B is created. If the same two Selves participate in a future FAI event, a new inter-Self perimeter is constructed for that event under the joint authority mechanics configured for it; it does not inherit a standing structure from the prior event unless the participating Selves' governance authorities explicitly configure it to do so as substrate content in the new event's configuration substrate.

4. Perimeter hierarchy across the trilogy

The inter-Self perimeter is the third rung on the governance-perimeter ladder the CKS trilogy builds across three papers.

Paper 1 (cell scope): The substrate-cell boundary.

Paper 1's governance perimeter is the boundary between the human-governed substrate and the LLM's execution under orchestration rules. On one side: all authoritative coordination state, governance semantics, and conflict-handling logic, subject to the three human rights. On the other: LLM execution reading from and writing to the substrate under rules. The perimeter is implicit in Paper 1's hybrid commitment; its architectural character is made explicit in the six Paper 1 commitments, most directly in the human-governance commitment and the substrate-as-coordination-artifact commitment.

Paper 2 (Self scope): The nested three-level home perimeter.

Paper 2 extends the governance perimeter concept to a three-level nested structure: cell governance perimeter within each cell, aspect governance perimeter within each aspect, and the Self home perimeter as the outermost boundary of the Paper 2 architecture. The instinct/reasoning boundary within each cell is a within-cell governance boundary specification — a further articulation of where substrate-mediated governance applies and where LLM-native fast-pattern processing operates. Together, these nested perimeters define the governance scope within which a single Self's architecture operates. This is the home perimeter that D1.03 asserts remains intact during an FAI event.

Paper 3 (inter-Self scope): The inter-Self perimeter added above home perimeters.

Paper 3 adds the inter-Self perimeter as a new governance scope that sits above the participating Selves' home perimeters in the sense that it spans across them. It does not replace the Paper 2 nested structure; that structure continues operating exactly as Paper 2 describes, within each participating Self's home perimeter. The inter-Self perimeter is the Paper 1 substrate commitment — a human-governed coordination medium with all six commitments holding — instantiated at the scope of inter-Self coordination rather than at cell scope. Paper 3 Claim 6 adds a further population perimeter at the outermost scope of the extension claim, spanning across many Selves' home perimeters at population scale.

The trilogy's governance-perimeter concept is thus one architectural primitive — the boundary within which human-governed substrate commitment operates — applied at progressively larger coordination scopes: cell, Self home, inter-Self, population. Each larger scope adds a new perimeter without removing or weakening the perimeters at smaller scopes.

5. Failure modes this sub-commitment defends against

Failure mode 1: Boundary dissolution through inter-organizational coordination.

An inter-organizational AI coordination architecture might dissolve participating organizations' governance boundaries as part of coordination — merging governance structures, subordinating one organization's authority to another's, or creating a unified joint governance structure that supersedes each participant's home governance. D1.03 forecloses this pattern: the inter-Self perimeter is additive; home perimeters are not absorbed into it. A shared substrate that weakened a participating Self's home governance as a side effect or precondition of coordination would not satisfy this sub-commitment.

Failure mode 2: Permanent inter-organizational governance dependencies.

An inter-organizational coordination mechanism might create lasting governance entanglements even after the specific coordination event that prompted it has completed — standing joint-governance boards, persistent shared-authority structures, ongoing cross-organizational approval requirements. D1.03 forecloses permanent dependencies specifically: the inter-Self perimeter dissolves at FAI completion. Any governance relationship between participating Selves after FAI dissolution is a matter for their own governance authorities to establish as new authored substrate content, not an artifact of the prior FAI event's inter-Self perimeter.

Failure mode 3: Ungoverned cross-boundary content.

A coordination mechanism might allow content to cross organizational boundaries without governance-configured provenance, depth controls, or attribution — treating cross-boundary content flow as an automatic technical operation rather than a governed exchange. D1.03 requires that content provenance crosses boundaries under governance configuration: how deeply provenance travels, what attribution it carries, and how it is managed within the inter-Self perimeter are all substrate-content decisions made under joint authority, not implicit properties of the technical exchange.

Failure mode 4: Flat multi-Self governance.

An inter-organizational coordination mechanism might treat all participating Selves as a single unified governance scope — one flat authority structure covering all participants equally — rather than maintaining distinct home perimeters with a separate inter-Self perimeter above them. Flat governance would eliminate the organizational governance independence that D1.03 protects: each Self's home governance authority over its own architecture would be replaced by a shared structure that no single Self fully controls. D1.03 requires the three-scope structure: Home A, Home B, and inter-Self as structurally distinct scopes with distinct authority structures.

6. Operational test

A shared substrate instantiates the D1.03 inter-Self governance perimeter sub-commitment if and only if all of the following are true during an active FAI event:

1. Inter-Self perimeter identifiable as distinct scope. There exists a governance boundary — the inter-Self perimeter — that encompasses the shared substrate's content and is distinct from either participating Self's home governance boundary. The authority structure governing the inter-Self perimeter is joint: both Selves' governance authorities participate in it, per governance-configured joint-authority mechanics that are themselves substrate content within the perimeter.

2. Home perimeters independently operative. Each participating Self's home governance authority continues to operate over that Self's internal architecture — cells, aspects, layers, and substrate content — without interruption, qualification, or deference to the FAI event or to the other Self's governance. A governance authority from Self A can, at any moment during the FAI event, exercise its inspect, modify, or override rights over Self A's home substrate content without requiring coordination with Self B's governance authority.

3. Configuration of joint authority is authored substrate content. The governance configuration of the inter-Self perimeter — how joint authority is exercised, what content crosses the boundary, how deeply provenance travels, what conflict-handling rules apply — is substrate content within the inter-Self perimeter. It is inspectable by the participating Selves' governance authorities, modifiable under those authorities, and subject to the three Paper 1 rights. It is not a fixed deployment parameter outside the governance scope.

4. Dissolution terminates the inter-Self perimeter without residue. When the FAI event completes, the inter-Self perimeter ceases to exist as a governance scope. No standing inter-organizational authority structure, approval requirement, or governance obligation persists between the participating Selves as an artifact of the dissolved perimeter. The participating Selves' home perimeters continue with the same authority structures they had before the FAI event.

A system that fails any of (1)–(4) may implement inter-organizational AI coordination in some other sense, but does not instantiate the D1.03 sub-commitment. In particular: a system in which a participating Self's home governance authority is weakened or suspended during coordination fails (2); a system in which cross-boundary governance configuration is opaque or outside the governance scope fails (3); a system in which the FAI event leaves standing inter-organizational governance obligations fails (4).

7. Conclusion

D1.03 formalizes the architectural commitment that the shared substrate's governance boundary constitutes a new, additive coordination scope — the inter-Self perimeter — that spans across the home governance perimeters of participating Selves without absorbing or weakening them. During an active FAI event, three governance scopes exist simultaneously: Home Perimeter A, Home Perimeter B, and the inter-Self perimeter, each with its own authority structure, each independently operative. The inter-Self perimeter is jointly governed by the participating Selves' governance authorities per governance-configured mechanics that are themselves substrate content within the perimeter. At FAI dissolution, the inter-Self perimeter terminates as a governance scope, leaving no permanent inter-organizational governance dependency. This sub-commitment is what makes inter-Self coordination architecturally compatible with organizational governance independence: the coordination mechanism adds a temporary shared scope without threatening the scopes that were there before it.

Source papers

Li, W. (2026a). *Coordination Outside the Model: A Human-Governed Substrate Pattern for AI Systems*. April 2026. ORCID: 0009-0004-8065-3235.

Li, W. (2026b). *The Instinct/Reasoning Separation Outside the Model: Extending the Coordination Knowledge Substrate Pattern to AI Selves under Human Governance*. April 2026. ORCID: 0009-0004-8065-3235.

Li, W. (2026c). *Inter-Self Coordination via Shared Substrate / Full Aspect Integration*. April 2026. ORCID: 0009-0004-8065-3235.

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